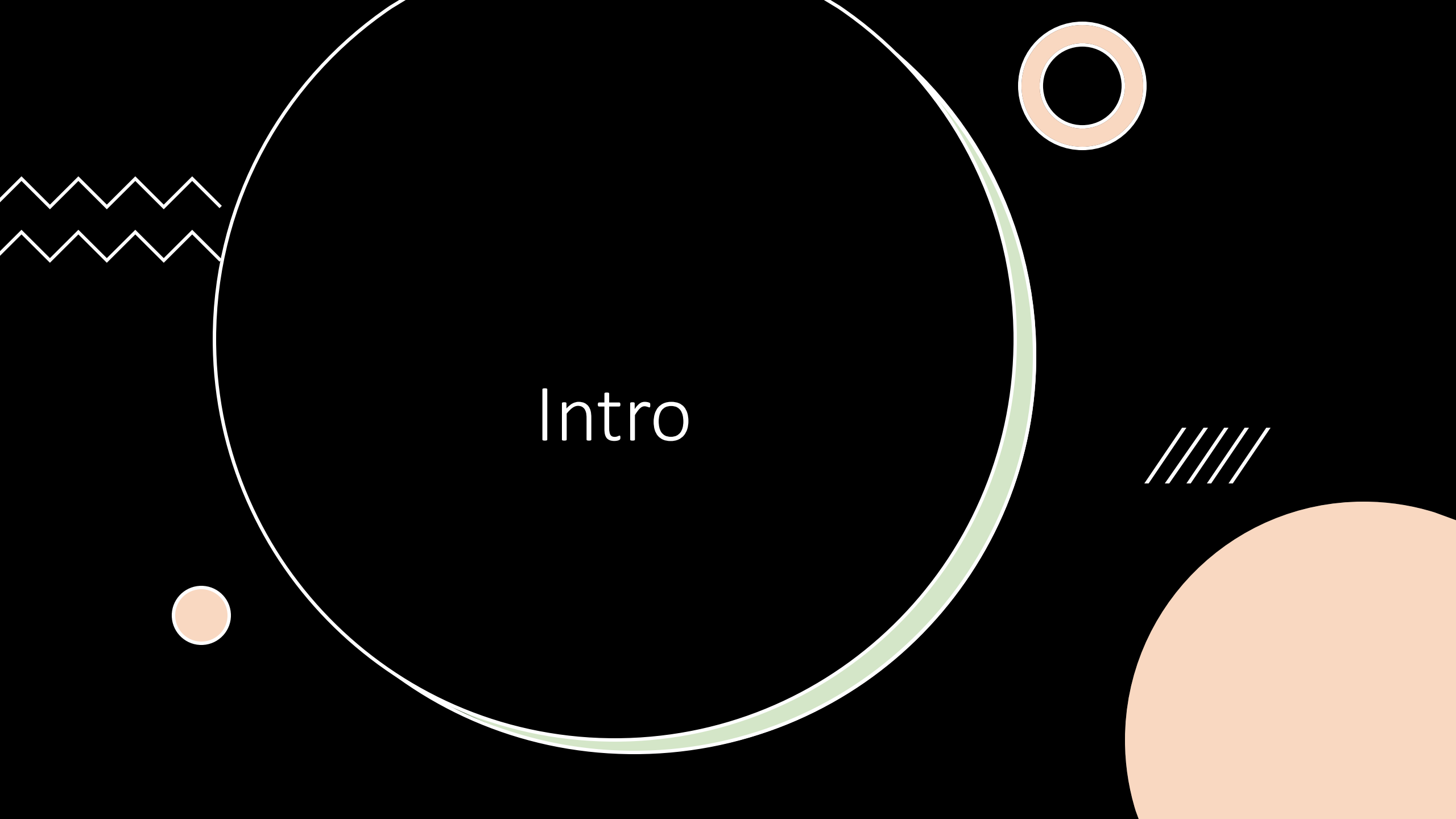


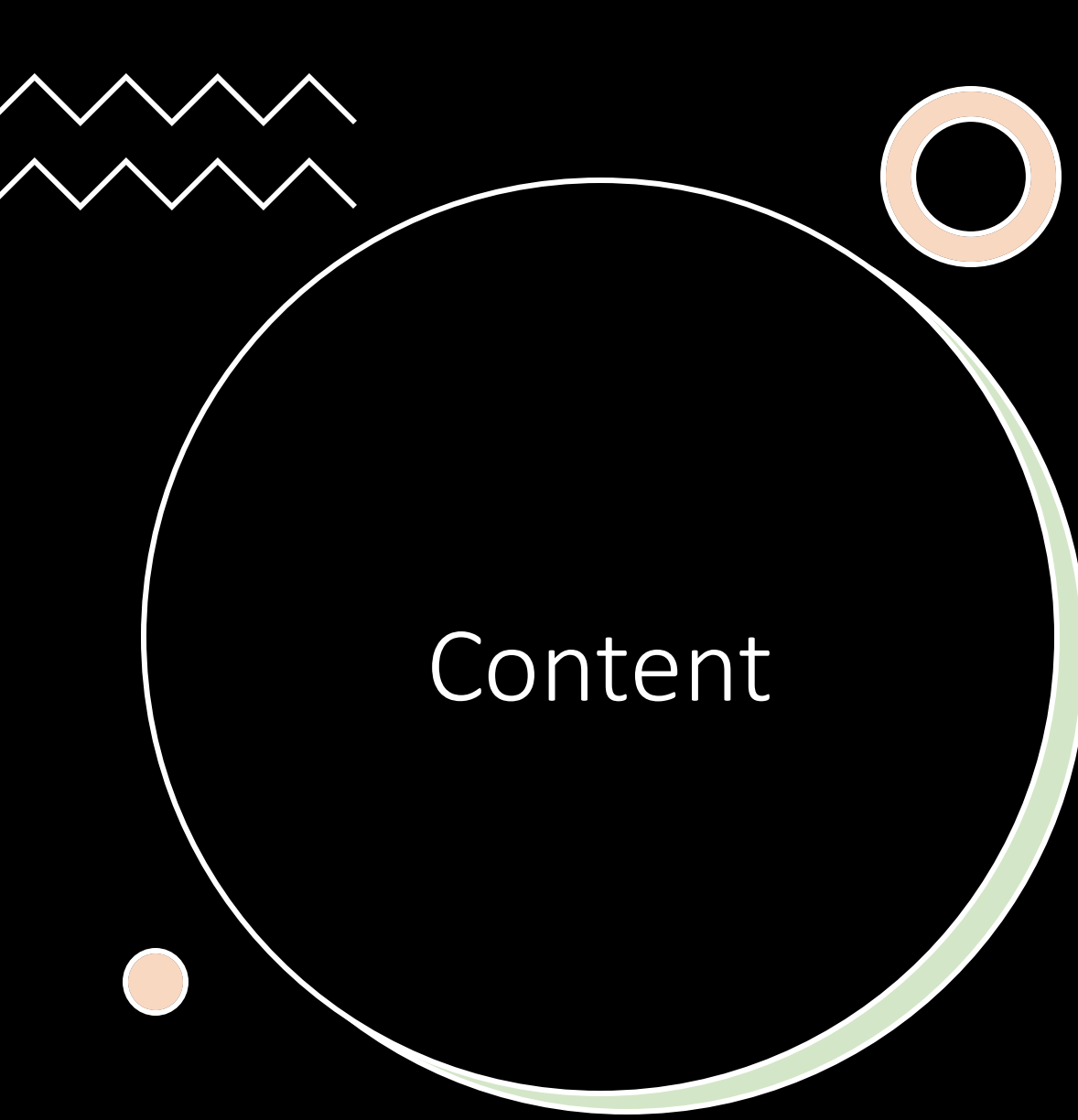
# Intersectional Communication



Dennie Declercq // Thursdays Matter // SEPT 2021

An abstract geometric design on a black background. A large circle with a thin white outline and a thick light green inner border is centered. The word "Intro" is written in white inside this circle. To the left of the circle, two white zigzag lines extend from the edge. Below the circle, a small solid light orange circle is positioned. To the right of the circle, a light orange ring is located. Further right, five parallel white diagonal lines are shown. In the bottom right corner, a large solid light orange circle is partially visible.

Intro



# Content

- Intro
- Customers
- Our roadmap to intersectional Communications
- The IT coaching methodology
- Customer scenario's
- Wrap up // Thanks // Q&A





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## Who am I?

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- Dennie Declercq
- President/ Developer/ IT Coach  
DDSoft vzw
- Microsoft MVP
- #DreamingIsBelieving
- @DennieDeclercq
- dennie@ddsoft.be

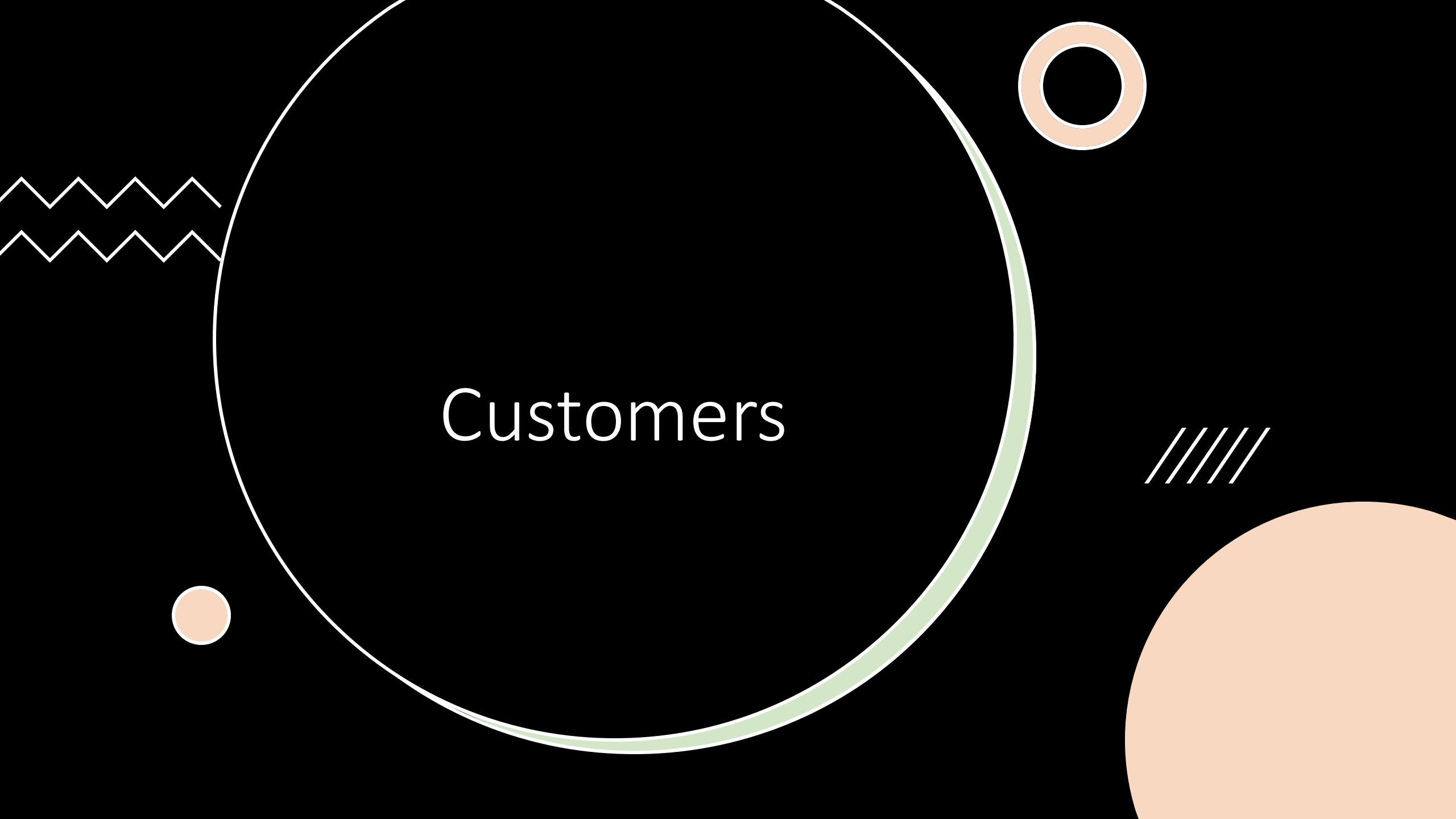




## Why this talk?

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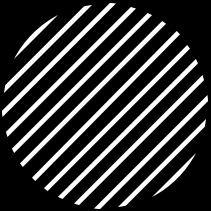
- Too many People live on their Island
  - The island of their main customer sector
- There's need in other sectors too
- Mismatch in understanding between different sectors

An abstract geometric design on a black background. A large circle with a thin white outline and a thick light green inner border is centered. The word "Customers" is written in white sans-serif font inside this circle. To the left of the circle, two white zigzag lines extend from the edge. Below the circle, a small solid light orange circle is positioned. To the right of the circle, a light orange ring is located in the upper right, and a set of four parallel white diagonal lines is in the middle right. In the bottom right corner, a large solid light orange circle is partially visible.

Customers



# Types of customers



- **Aligning customers**
  - Have (basic) computer knowledge
  - Have (basic) shared terminology
- **Non-aligning customers**
  - Have complete different terminology
  - Have complete other jargon

# Aligning Customers Sectors



Line of Business  
customers



Retail  
customers

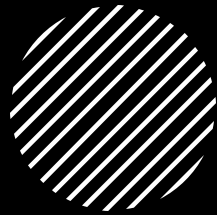


Accountants





# Non aligning customers sectors



- Social sector:
  - Psychologists
  - (Life) coaches
  - Massage therapists
  - Self-support groups
  - Organizations for people with social needs
  - Social entrepreneurs



# Common language?

## Aligning Customer Sectors

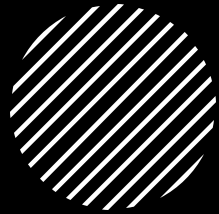
- Common language works great
- It's build for this group

## Non Aligning Customers

- Way more work to find common language



Crazy misfits

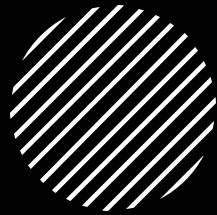


- Landing pages
- A Client
- Too expensive
- Too cheap





# Goals and expectations



- Timing
- Customer content
  - Ready & clear
  - Not ready & clear
- Pricing







Our road to  
Intersectional  
customers

# Before March 2020

2015

start of DDSof

- Software Idea's for people with disabilities

Public international conference speaker

Less time for customers

2017–Mar. 2020

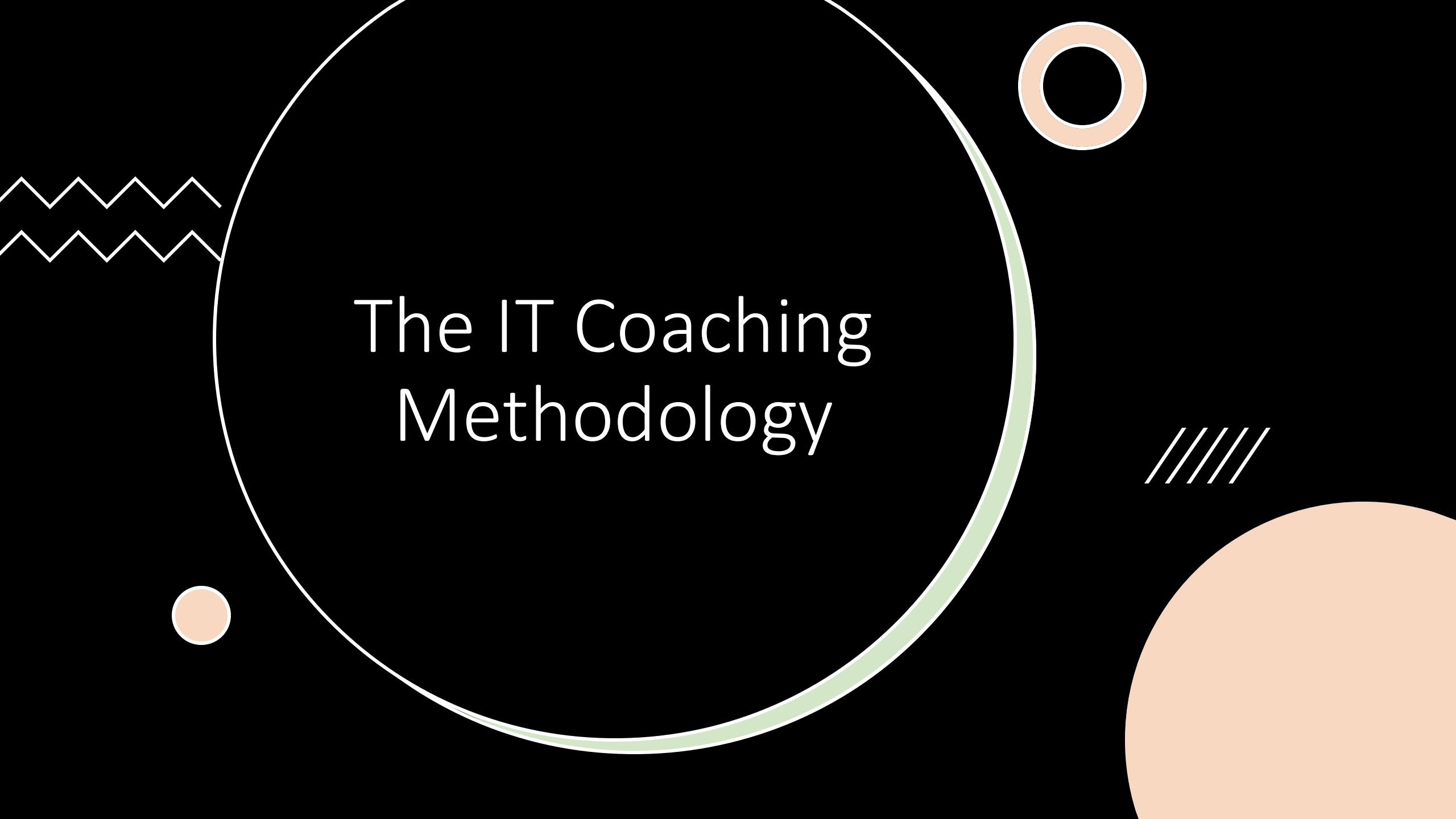
# The pandemic

- No conference travels
- Anxiety
- Needed an 'escape'
- An idea:
  - Helping customers help their people online/ virtual
- A lot of interest
  - Domino effect

# The need

- A lot of people need digital tools
  - Don't have basic know-how
- IT has 'a bad name' in the social field
- The social field has 'a bad name' for IT companies





# The IT Coaching Methodology







# Coach next to client

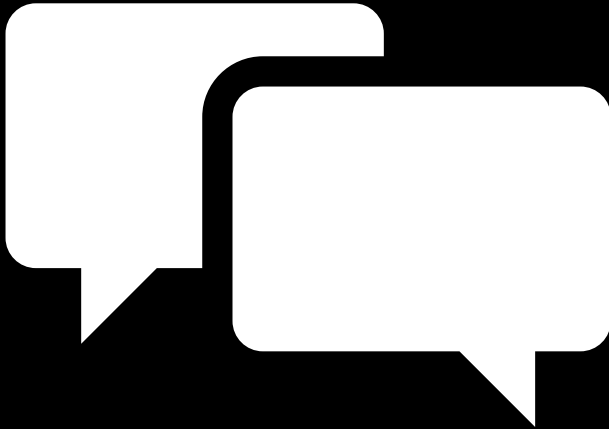
- No top – bottom
- Not IT'er knows it all vs client/ customer don't know how it works
- Coach helps thinking as client would like
- Client's ideas are key
- Coach helps to build clients dreams



## Question driven

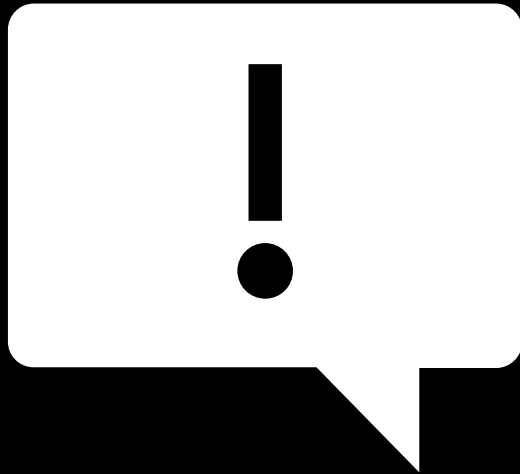
- Client asks questions
- Client helps making the agenda
  - Even brings most of the topics on the agenda
- Coach can steer is something not possible [yet]

# Clean Communication



- It's important to help client formulate their need good
- To help them to communicate their need
- Sometimes jargon makes it really difficult to find their need
- Say clear and clean what's possible and what's not
- Be clear about pricing
- No hidden costs!

# Avoid Assuming

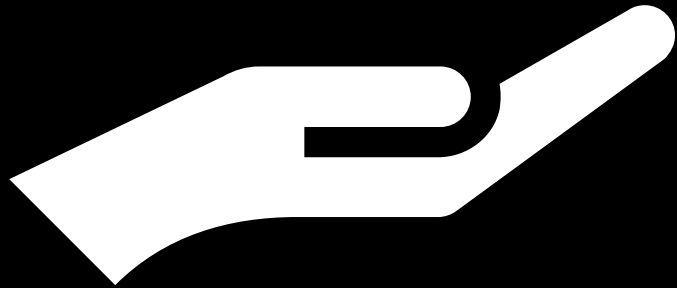


- Don't assume what your client want
- If something is not clear:
  - Mail
  - Call
  - Text
- Don't assume and build into the product!

# Own Knowledge

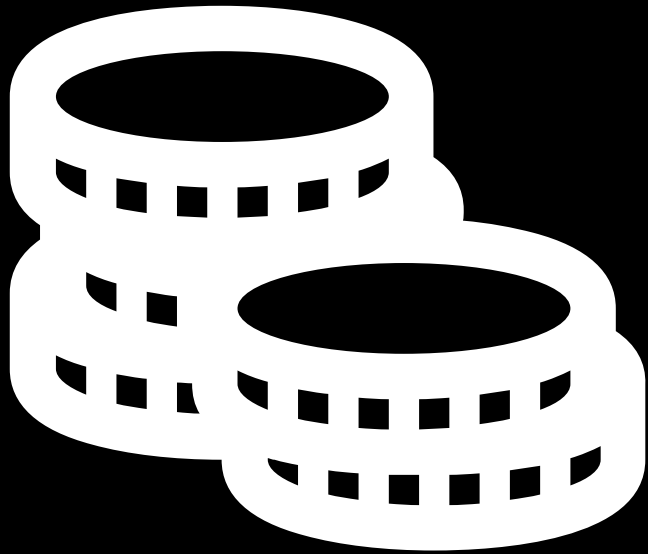


- IT people/ developer have own knowledge
  - That's really important:
    - Security
    - Accessibility
    - Best practices



# Bringing own knowledge to client

- Communicate
- Explain
- Educate
- BUT client is key!



# Subscriptions

- Work subscription based
- Customer paid par monthly subscription
- Developing/ configuring/ IT coach conversations...

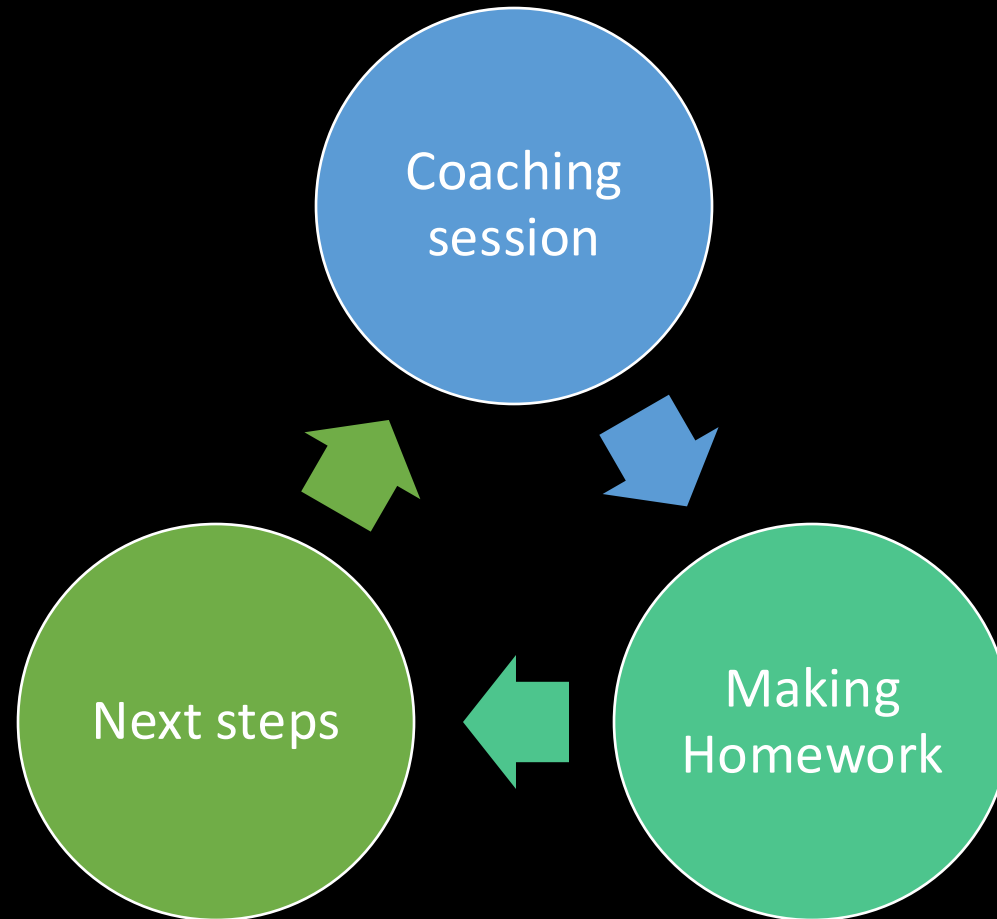
# Intake

- The Customer's dream
- Budget

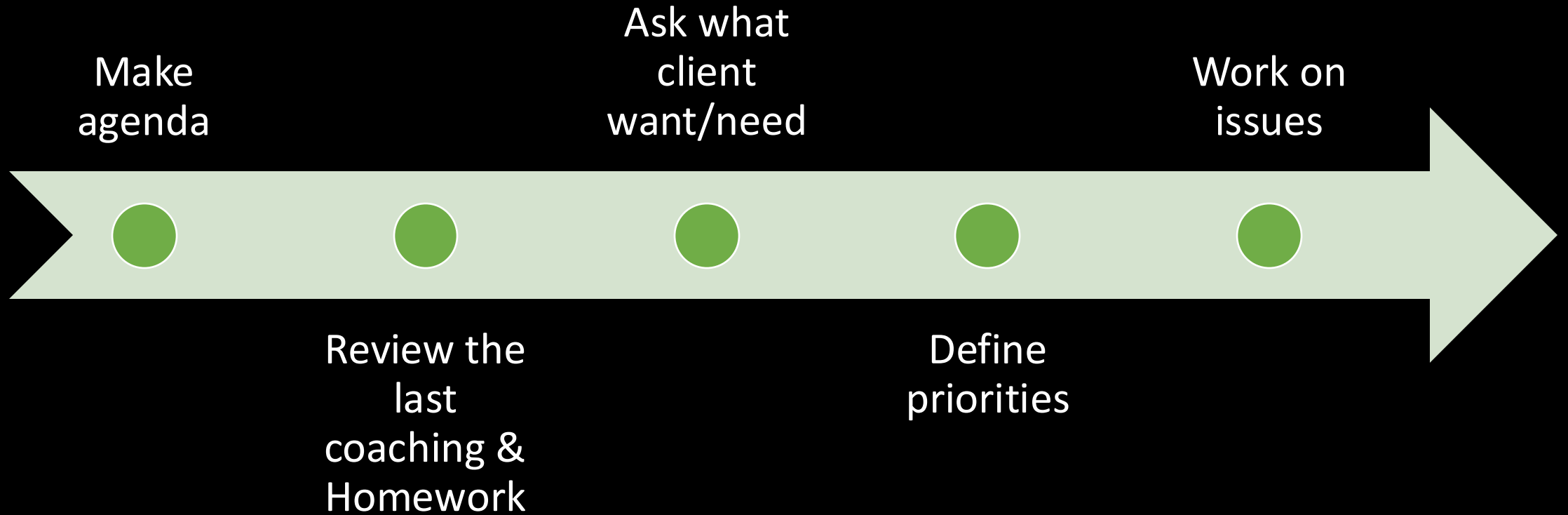


# The IT-Coaching lifecycle

*Agile Based!*



# Coaching sessions



# Homework

## For Client



WORKING ON  
CONTENT



EXERCISING



PLANNING

## For Coach

- Developing
- Designing
- Configuring
- Recording
- Making of resources



'Home' dev

- Time hours
- Price is the same as coaching sessions
- Be clear on what you did
- Can be in own offices
- Without customer





# Customer Scenarios

# The Gym

*First one*

*Before the pandemic*

*“You need to ask way more money otherwise the board wouldn’t buy in!”*

*“Let met think.....”*

*“Our old IT seller didn’t listen and was too expensive”*

# Figures

*“I want a landing page”*

*“But I can’t explain”*

*Our mistake: “Fixed price” – the last fixed price*

*Our estimation: “Modernizing old website”*

*Customer expectation: “Making brand new website”*

# The Bee

*A phone call: "Dennie we need to have a conversation.."*

*"yes, and...." (Anxious)*

*"Can you make a new price..."*

*"You ask way too less"*

*"Oh key, let me make something...."*



# My old coach

*“Do you want a coffee?”*

*“Of course”*

*“I can make your website!”*

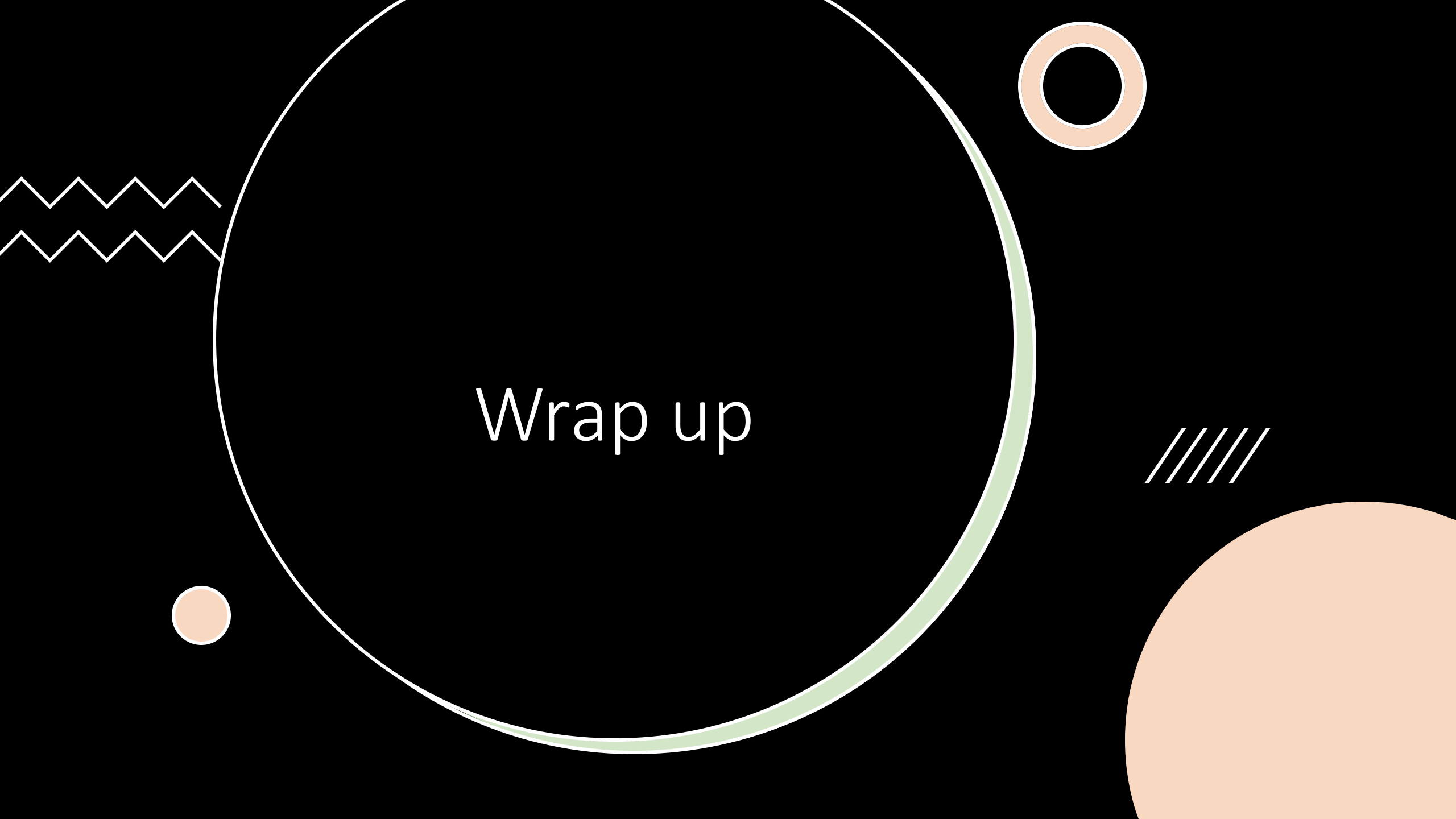
*“But I thought you were only working for people with disabilities..”*

*“NOPE, we changed”*

*“Lot’s of coffees, meetings”*

*“Fun, Fun, Fun!”*

*“Even in the middle of the pandemic”*

The image features a large, thin white circle centered on a black background. Inside this circle, the text "Wrap up" is written in a white, sans-serif font. Surrounding the central circle are several decorative elements: a thick light green arc on the right side of the circle, a small orange circle at the bottom left, a larger orange circle at the top right, a white zigzag line on the left, and a series of white diagonal lines on the right. A large, solid orange circle is partially visible in the bottom right corner.

Wrap up



# Thanks / Q&A

- #DreamingIsBelieving
- @DennieDeclercq
- dennie@ddsoft.be

